

make sure or look for a YouTube video), make sure your GPU can fit inside your case and you have enough mounting brackets for your storage, both 3.5 and 2.5-inches (all of this can be found on the motherboard and case manufacturer's website). And please don't pair a CPU with an unlocked multiplier (Usually signified by a K suffix in Intel processors which effectively means that you can vary the voltage supplied to the chip to overclock it) with a board incapable of overclocking. Right now, a big problem is that the 100 series motherboards from Intel, i.e. Z170, H170, B150, H110 chipset boards are not compatible with Kabylake processors unless they have had their BIOSs updated. Make sure that your motherboard was produced recently or your vendor has updated the BIOS themselves with a Skylake CPU. You can NOT update the BIOS with a Kabylake processor in there. Or, you could just purchase a 200 series motherboard to ensure compatibility. On the AMD side of things, do note that you can't use aftermarket coolers without special AM4 mounting brackets. You'll have to request these from your cooler manufacturer and they'll usually ship it to you for free. <https://in.pcpartpicker.com/> is your saviour here. It'll automatically warn you of any incompatibilities. Oh, and if you are building a small form factor or SFF case, we recommend getting a blower style GPU (one that exhausts it's air outside the case) because you'll get cooler temperatures this way and not heat up the inside of your case. For a regular mATX or ATX build where cooling doesn't come at a premium due to space, normal aftermarket cards with factory overclocks beat the reference blower cards both in temperatures and performance and are worth paying the premium for over the latter.

Prep for the build: The build itself can take quite a while so make sure you do it when you are least likely to be interrupted. Having a good (and preferably long) Phillips head screwdriver and a designated screw and other small part holders is a must. There will be a lot of them, so if you can somehow mark which screws are which, it'll really help you out. First things first, ground yourself before you handle any of the components. Static electricity may not seem like a huge problem until you end up frying a component. Wear rubber sandals (no socks please!) or go barefoot and touch a 'grounded' piece of metal, something like a window grill for example. Anti Electrostatic Discharge Bracelets and Mats are a thing but you usually won't need to go to that extreme although it's always better to err on the side of caution. If you can afford the extra cost or you are building a lot of components, AESD bracelets are always a welcome addition. Clear your